

COLUMN ONE

Pay phones tapped for one last call

An art project called the Goodbye Line prompts passersby to leave a message. People are dialing.

By Todd Martens

Alexis Wood received a notification on her phone. It was an anonymous call from a pay phone. She listened and was momentarily paralyzed. And then she couldn't stop crying.

The call wasn't completely unexpected. Days earlier, Wood and her partner, Adam Trunell, had gone prowling for working Los Angeles pay phones, placing stickers on them that invited passersby to make a free call to a recorded line to "say goodbye." What surprised her was the message.

The voice on the other end of the line sounded like a young man, who confessed that he thought the toll-free 888 number would allow him to call his mother. Once he realized it wouldn't, he pivoted and followed the recorded prompt to say goodbye — "to remember, to pay respects, to turn the page" — to a loved one or part of yourself.

"I'd like to apologize to my family," the voice said. "I hope y'all make it to heaven. I'm sorry I didn't make it." It was short but powerful and Wood listened to it again on repeat.

"I started to cry," Wood says, sitting with Trunell in a downtown coffee shop. "I didn't realize this was going to have that effect on me, that this was a very real, authentic moment for someone."

Alternately rebellious and nostalgic, the Goodbye Line is a relatively new art project found on pay phones throughout the L.A. area.

"Yes, this payphone works" the stickers read in blocky text against a red-and-white backdrop. The instructions continue with the line, "Someday, these will be gone, like you, me, and everyone else," prior to inviting readers to leave a message "before it's too late." People are calling.

"Goodbye is such a part of life," says Trunell, a documentary filmmaker who started the experiment with Wood last year. "It's all us coming and going, coming and going. We all share that. And it makes it less lonely, less scary. Not that it makes it easier."

Calls do range in tone. At a pay phone in Hollywood, [See Goodbye, A9]



ADAM TRUNELL Goodbye Line

"GOODBYE is such a part of life," says Adam Trunell, a documentary filmmaker who started the experiment with his partner, Alexis Wood, last year. The farewells can be to loved ones, pets or something more abstract.



Photographs by JULIANA YAMADA Los Angeles Times

Local business owners brace for higher costs in tariff swing

Small shops that rely on imports, especially discretionary items, say duties put them in a dilemma.

By Caroline Petrow-Cohen and Malia Mendez

Since immigrating to the United States in 2009, Riyadh Ladadwa has made a living buying and selling produce. The Palestinian businessman owns Diamond Fresh Farmers Market in Diamond Bar and relies on goods shipped from Mexico and other countries.

Ladadwa said his business is successful because he's able to offer inexpensive products, but as President Trump's aggressive tariffs are set to take effect, it will be hard to keep prices low. Produce from Mexico, in [See Importers, A11]



CARLIN STIEHL For The Times

CHRISTINA Mullin, who runs Miracle Mile Toys & Gifts, views the tariffs as just the latest disaster for the retail market in L.A.

RETREAT: Stocks give up some gains from the day before amid fears of U.S.-China trade war. BUSINESS, A10

12 protesters charged with felonies

The pro-Palestinian activists are accused of breaking into and vandalizing Stanford administration offices.

By Susanne Rust, Howard Blume and Jaweed Kaleem

Prosecutors on Thursday announced felony charges against 12 pro-Palestinian protesters — all but one current and former Stanford students or graduates — who in June allegedly broke



Nic CORY Associated Press

THE CHARGES are among the most serious faced by those involved in campus protests over Gaza war.

into and vandalized a Stanford University administration building, barricading themselves inside before being arrested that same day.

The charges against the 12 appear to represent the most serious prosecution en masse to date in California of those arrested during demonstrations and encampments that roiled campuses last spring in protest of Israel's war in Gaza.

"Dissent is American. Vandalism is criminal," said Santa Clara County Dist. Atty. Jeff Rosen. "There is a bright line between making a point and committing a [See Stanford, A8]

TRUMP TARGETS STATE CLIMATE LAWS

Executive order could block California's cap-and-trade program and carbon emission policies.

By Hayley Smith

The Trump administration this week ramped up its efforts to scale back environmental protections nationwide with a sweeping executive order aimed at undermining states' abilities to set their own policies, including key components of California's fight against climate change.

In an order dated April 8, the president directed Atty. Gen. Pam Bondi to identify and "stop the enforcement of" state laws that address climate change and other environmental initiatives.

"Many States have enacted, or are in the process of enacting, burdensome and ideologically motivated 'climate change' or energy policies that threaten American energy dominance and our economic and national security," the president wrote in the executive order.

"These State laws and policies are fundamentally irreconcilable with my Administration's objective to unleash American energy," he wrote. "They should not stand."

The assertion of federal power over states' rights seems to go against some of Trump's other positions — he campaigned, for example, on states' rights for issues such as abortion. The order calls out several states specifically, including New York and Vermont, which he accuses of "extorting" fossil-fuel companies for their past contributions to planet-warming greenhouse gas emissions.

The order also takes aim at California's cap-and-trade program — a first-of-its-kind initiative that sets limits on companies' greenhouse gas emissions and allows them to sell "credits" for unused emissions to other companies.

"California, for example, punishes carbon use by adopting impossible caps on the amount of carbon businesses may use, all but forcing businesses to pay large sums to 'trade' carbon credits to meet California's radical requirements," the president wrote.

The executive order marks a continuation of Trump's recent anti-environmental efforts, which have included cuts to grant funding, widespread office closures and layoffs in the climate research community, loosened regulations and renewed ef [See Climate, A11]

Edison mum on changes to grounding policy

How crews handle idle transmission towers was altered after Eaton fire

By Salvador Hernandez

Just weeks after the deadly Eaton fire ignited near three Southern California Edison transmission towers, the utility quietly changed an internal policy on how crews should ground idle electrical pylons.

The change attracted little attention at the time — due mostly to the fact that early suspicion about the cause of the blaze focused on two active transmission towers in Eaton Canyon.

But in recent weeks, speculation about the origin of the fire has shifted to a third idle transmission tower that had been unused

for more than five decades.

Despite these revelations, Southern California Edison — and the state commission tasked with regulating utilities — has refused to disclose what changes Edison made to how it grounds idle transmission towers, or what prompted the company to make the change days after its crews were al-

lowed to inspect the hillside where the blaze erupted.

The California Public Utilities Commission has ignored questions and denied a public records request from the Times regarding Edison's actions. The request could help shine a light on what officials have learned during their inspection [See Edison, A8]

Wrongly deported man gets court win But justices stop short of ordering the Trump administration to return him to the U.S. NATION, A6

Agents denied entry at 2 schools

The unannounced visits come amid fears of deportation among immigrants. CALIFORNIA, B1

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 82/56. B5

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Doncic builds his support network

In his Dallas homecoming, teary-eyed superstar carries the Lakers to victory. SPORTS, B10

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